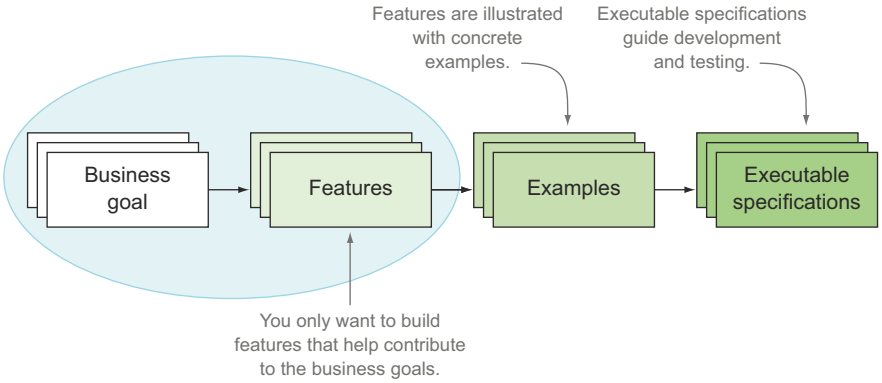


Figure 3.1 In this chapter we'll focus on discovering the features that will add real value to the business.

requirements and assumptions often change during the life of a project. It's unproductive to try to draw up detailed specifications in the initial phases of a project, when you know relatively little about it: this just sets you up for rework later, when the requirements, or your understanding of them, inevitably change. Instead, you should try to build a deep understanding of the business context behind the project so that you can react appropriately to change and remain focused on delivering the value that the business expects from the project. This is what we'll focus on in this chapter (see figure 3.1).

BDD places great emphasis on building "software that matters" and defines several processes for turning client requirements into something that developers can use to code against and that accurately reflects the core values of the software the client wants.

To ensure that the team is focusing on building valuable features, business analysts will find it useful to identify four things:

1. Why is the software being built (what is the project's *vision statement*)?
2. How will the project deliver value to the organization (what are the project's *business goals*)?
3. What *stakeholders* are involved in the project, and how will the project affect them?
4. What high-level *capabilities* should the software provide for stakeholders to enable them to achieve their business goals more effectively?

Techniques such as *Feature Injection*, *Impact Mapping*, and the *Purpose-Based Alignment Model* can help identify how the project will benefit the organization and what features can best realize those benefits:

- *Feature Injection* takes BDD beyond scenarios and stories and can help you discover what features you really need to satisfy the underlying business goals of a project.
- *Impact Mapping* helps you identify and visualize the relationships between business goals, stakeholders, and features.